

Evidence Quality

Workbook 1 - Learn - Focused practice

Directions

Work slowly. Identify exactly what the source says before you decide what the evidence can support.

Exercise 1

A school claims a new water station increases hydration. A survey shows students like the station's design.

Task: How should the survey be evaluated?

- A. Relevant and sufficient.
- B. Not very relevant to whether hydration increased.
- C. Proof that dehydration ended.
- D. Sufficient because surveys are always strong.

Exercise 2

A store says a new checkout layout reduces waiting. Average wait time fell by 90 seconds during a two-week pilot.

Task: Which statement is most accurate?

- A. The evidence is relevant to waiting time, but more data may be needed before a permanent chain-wide change.
- B. The evidence is irrelevant because it uses numbers.
- C. The pilot proves every store will improve equally.
- D. No conclusion at all can be drawn.

Exercise 3

A manager claims a new scheduling app caused fewer late starts. Late starts declined, but the company also changed shift supervisors that week.

Task: Why is the evidence insufficient to establish causation?

- A. Late starts are not measurable.
- B. Another major change occurred at the same time.
- C. Apps cannot affect schedules.
- D. Supervisors never affect work.

Exercise 4

A town wants to know whether a new shade structure reduces afternoon heat at a playground.

Task: Which evidence is most relevant?

- A. Afternoon surface-temperature readings before and after installation.
- B. The playground opening date.
- C. The number of parks in the county.
- D. A history of playground design.

Answer reasoning

Check your reasoning, not only your answer.

For every question, compare your reasoning with the explanation. If you missed the item, identify the exact step where your reasoning changed the source or used evidence for the wrong job.

Exercise 1

Best answer: B. Not very relevant to whether hydration increased.

Why: Design preference does not measure drinking behavior or hydration.

Exercise 2

Best answer: A. The evidence is relevant to waiting time, but more data may be needed before a permanent chain-wide change.

Why: It measures the claim directly, yet the scope and duration limit how broad the conclusion can be.

Exercise 3

Best answer: B. Another major change occurred at the same time.

Why: The evidence does not isolate the app from the supervisor change.

Exercise 4

Best answer: A. Afternoon surface-temperature readings before and after installation.

Why: They directly measure the temperature outcome named in the claim.

Mistake check

For every miss, label the reason: wrong claim, evidence mismatch, too broad or too certain, reasoning gap, source or format confusion, or rushed reading. Then write one sentence explaining what you will check next time.